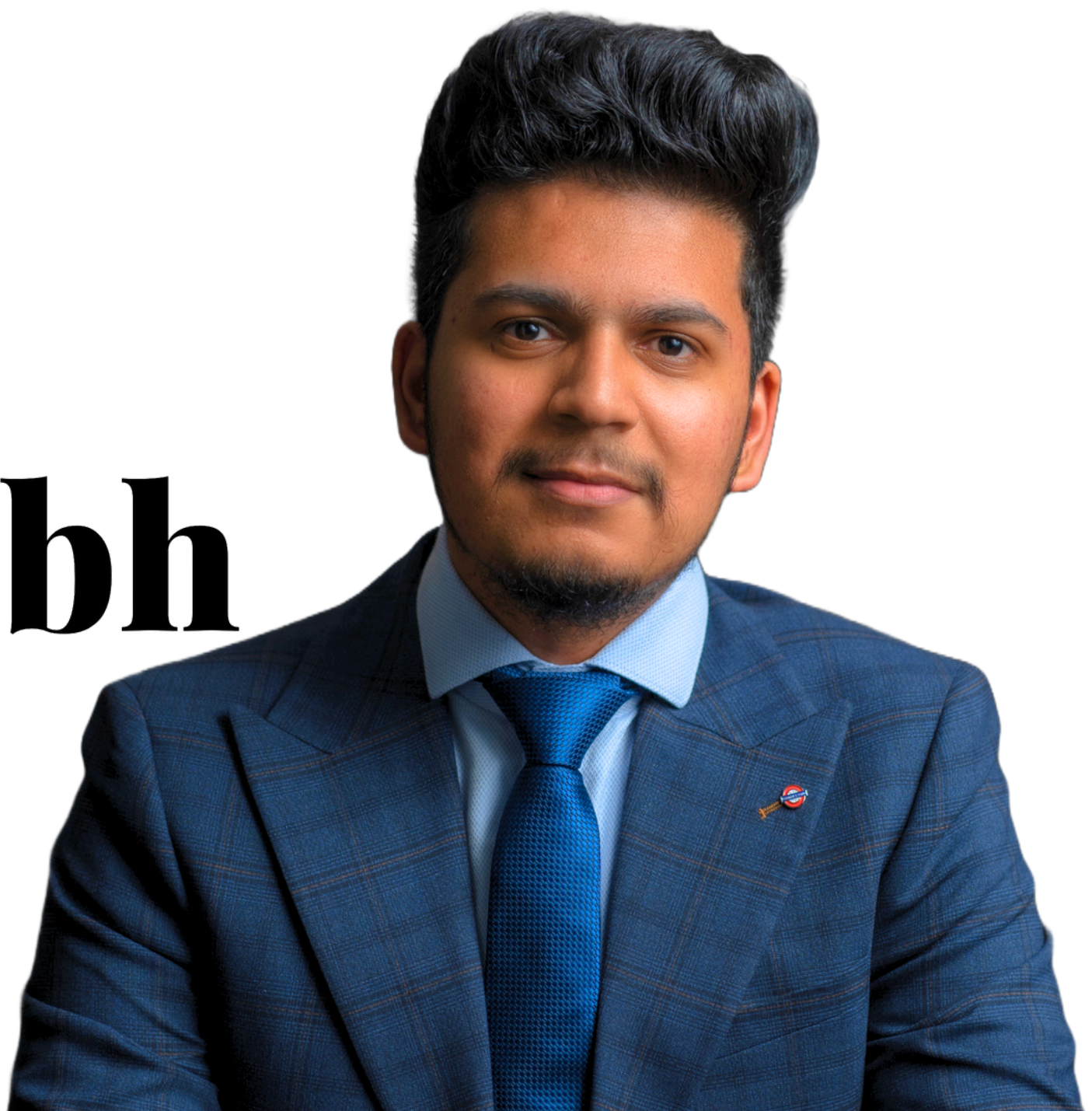




Unlocking

HOME OWNERSHIP

Homes by
Rishabh



**A friendly, step-by-step roadmap
for first-time homebuyers in Calgary, Alberta**

This guide is for educational purposes only, specific to Calgary, Alberta.
It should not be considered legal or tax advice.



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TREC
THE REAL ESTATE COMPANY

Why Calgary?

Calgary has no provincial sales tax, a strong job market, and neighbourhoods for every budget. It's a great city to buy in- if you're financially ready. Here's how to know.

Financial Qualifications:

Hack: Paying down existing debt before you apply is the fastest way to increase your buying power.

Get Pre-Approved First. In Calgary's market, a pre-approval is your entry ticket. It shows sellers you're serious and locks in your rate for 90–120 days. If rates rise while you search, you're protected. If they drop, you benefit. There's no downside.

Your Down Payment:

- 5% on the first \$500,000
- 10% on anything above \$500,000
- 20% required at \$1,000,000+

Anything under 20% means CMHC mortgage insurance is added to your loan.

Open an FHSA — Today, the First Home Savings Account lets you contribute \$8,000/year (up to \$40,000 lifetime). Contributions are tax-deductible. Withdrawals for a first home are tax-free. It's the best savings tool available to first-time buyers and most people aren't using it yet.



The Search

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Build Your Team:

- **REALTOR®** — I help you to find homes, red flags during viewings, and run a Comparative Market Analysis to derive a fair market value. Plus, negotiate the best price and terms on your behalf — closing dates, conditions, all of it.
- **Mortgage Broker** — Shops dozens of lenders to find the best rates for your home buying.
- **Real Estate Lawyer** — Handles your closing process and protects you.
- **Home Inspector** — Gives you an objective, top-to-bottom assessment of the home's condition before you commit.

Hack: I can connect you with my trusted partners and make sure everyone is on the same page throughout your purchase.

Choosing Your Calgary Neighbourhood

Think about what actually matters to your daily life: CTrain access, schools, commute time, or proximity to parks and amenities. Don't just buy the house — buy the location.

Making an Offer. What are conditions?

- **Financing** — Time to formally confirm your mortgage. Never waive this.
- **Home Inspection** — Know exactly what you're buying before you commit.
- **Condo Document Review** — For condos only. A healthy reserve fund matters as much as the unit itself.



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Budget for Closing Costs–

Set aside 1.5–2% of your purchase price beyond your down payment. On a \$600,000 home, that's \$9,000–\$12,000. It covers:

- **Legal fees:** \$1,500–\$2,500
- **Home inspection:** ~\$500
- **Property tax adjustment:** You reimburse the seller for any taxes prepaid past possession day.

The 10-Day Checklist

- Sign documents with your lawyer.
- Depositing your remaining down payment and closing costs.
- Confirm home insurance is active by possession day.
- Get utilities transferred on your name by possession day.
- Do a final walkthrough with me within 24 hours of possession.

Possession Day

In Alberta, possession is usually at noon. Keys are released only after the funds sent by your lawyer land in the seller's lawyer's account and the title officially transfers. Don't book your movers for 8 AM. Noon or later is realistic.

Your First Week

- Change all locks and garage codes.
- Update your address. Notify your bank, employer, and subscriptions.
- Calgary-Specific: Register for your My Calgary Account at calgary.ca



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Get in touch today!

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